

Travis Truax

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Professional Summary

Senior Software Engineer with 6+ years of experience designing, building, and operating distributed AWS systems in compliance-heavy global trade and customs domains. I do my best work when systems are complex, timelines are tight, and precision matters: turning regulatory change, vendor systems, and high-volume event flows into production systems that teams can understand and trust. Strong background in backend engineering, cloud infrastructure, reliability, and technical leadership, with a bias toward precise fixes that solve the core issue and reduce operational disruption.

Core Competencies

- **DISTRIBUTED SYSTEMS** → Event-driven services, asynchronous workflows, failure-mode design
- **AWS CLOUD** → Lambda, Step Functions, API Gateway, DynamoDB, S3, EC2, ECS
- **BACKEND ENGINEERING** → Python, REST APIs, service design, workflow orchestration
- **INFRASTRUCTURE & DEVOPS** → Terraform, CI/CD, Docker, ECS, repeatable deployment patterns
- **OBSERVABILITY & RELIABILITY** → CloudWatch, Splunk, OpenTelemetry, tracing, incident response
- **DATA & INTEGRATIONS** → SQS/SNS, Kafka, large-file pipelines, tariff and customs data providers, IBM, Box
- **TECHNICAL LEADERSHIP** → Architecture direction, code review, mentoring, delivery through ambiguity
- **SECURITY FOUNDATIONS** → Detection engineering, access control, credential rotation, Kerberos analysis

Work Experience

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER | NIKE INC. | GLOBAL TRADE AND CUSTOMS 03/2021 – 04/2026

- Led design of event-driven serverless workflows with Lambda, Step Functions, SQS/SNS, and DynamoDB, processing millions of purchase orders and thousands of customs events per hour at peak
- Turned urgent regulatory changes, including reciprocal tariffs and HTS updates, into production-ready workflows and operational playbooks under tight timelines
- Delivered customs classification and estimated duty systems that supported multi-country tariff logic, compliance reviews, and downstream broker filing workflows
- Drove incident response for classification outages, API failures, vendor integration issues, and data-quality problems, staying with problems through root cause and durable fixes
- Raised observability standards with Splunk, CloudWatch, OpenTelemetry, and runbooks so engineers could debug and own systems in production
- Designed vendor integrations and data feeds across tariff/customs providers, document platforms, and downstream ERP systems, with large-file processing, asynchronous pipelines, and clear failure handling
- Contributed heavily to internal platform modernization, using Terraform, ECS, and CI/CD patterns to make service deployments more repeatable
- Served as interim Tech Lead by setting delivery direction, reviewing designs and code, mentoring engineers, and keeping the team moving through a leadership transition

CLOUD ENGINEER | NIKE INC. | AZURE ENGINEERING 09/2020 – 03/2021

- Built PowerShell runbooks to automate Azure deployments, inventory, and permission audits
- Queried deployed Azure infrastructure to give engineering teams a clearer view of ownership, access, and operational state
- Helped standardize repeatable cloud operations during Nike's broader cloud engineering transition

CYBER SECURITY ANALYST | NIKE INC. | NIKE CYBER DEFENSE CENTER 03/2020 – 09/2020

- Designed and built a serverless AWS solution to automate incident-ticket auditing and reduce manual security operations review
- Built dashboards for security operations metrics, detection coverage, and analyst reporting
- Led detection work for Kerberos abuse and tuned dashboards to surface suspicious authentication behavior
- Participated in Purple Team exercises to validate detections against realistic attacker behavior

SOFTWARE ENGINEER | NIKE INC. | TRADE TEAM 09/2019 – 03/2020

- Built Terraform-managed AWS infrastructure and Python REST APIs with Okta SSO for trade and customs workflows
- Helped establish microservice and CI/CD patterns with Jenkins for a team moving from manual delivery toward repeatable releases
- Delivered a broker-facing endpoint that consolidated customs data and product details needed for filings

IT INFRASTRUCTURE INTERN | GEORGE FOX UNIVERSITY**2017 – 2019**

- Supported campus infrastructure operations across network, server-room, installation, and troubleshooting work

HEAVY HAUL TRUCK DRIVER | RIVERBROOK TRUCKING**2012 – 2019**

- Operated heavy transport under strict safety, permitting, routing, and regulatory constraints
- Planned and executed legal movement of loads up to 16 ft wide, 16 ft high, and 250,000 lbs GVW across the Pacific Northwest

Additional Experience

PACIFIC REGION COLLEGIATE CYBER DEFENSE COMPETITION | TEAM CAPTAIN**2018 – 2019**

- Served as Team Captain for George Fox's first Collegiate Cyber Defense Competition team and qualified for Regionals
- Led 8 cybersecurity majors operating, defending, and hardening a corporate network under active attack simulations

COMMERCIAL DRIVER'S LICENSE (CLASS A) | SALEM, OR**2016 – Present**

Education

GEORGE FOX UNIVERSITY | NEWBERG OR**2015 – 2019**

- Bachelor of Science, Computer Science (emphasis in Cybersecurity)

Relevant Projects

COMPUTER VISION FOR AGRICULTURAL AUTOMATION**2018 – 2019**

- Developed a crop-identification system using computer vision as part of an interdisciplinary agricultural automation project